a reconciliation with BI. This would depend on the company submitting its accounts for scrutiny by government-appointed experts. Further, the government would be at liberty to publish the proceedings and reports of such a scrutiny. If the directors were not ready for this ordeal, he suggested, the government could publish the negotiations and leave the public to draw its own conclusions. The idea was not just to kill the Swadeshi company but also to tarnish its reputation and besmirch VOC's name. However, Murray Hammick disagreed with Atkinson's endorsement of the idea saying that the advantage to the government was slight. Other members too agreed with this assessment. Finally, Wynch was informed that the government was 'strongly opposed' to any intervention, and that it would 'only increase any feeling there may be at present against Government and its officers'. Evidently, the views of the local officials on ground zero and those at the higher reaches differed.

On 2 December 1908, Wynch handed over charge to S.W.G.I. MacIver. In the eventful year as Tirunelveli's collector and district magistrate, he had served the colonial state well and finished the job assigned to him with no scruples. Yet, even for an experienced hand like Wynch, his time in Tirunelveli could not have been easy. VOC's defiance and the upheaval of March 1908 gave his official animosity a personal touch. Within a week of Wynch demitting charge, Ashe was posted to Sattur, in the same district, as sub-collector and joint magistrate and the two missed each other narrowly. Wynch was so involved in crushing SSNCo that he could not hold himself back from reporting the following to his former accomplice: 'The Swadeshi people are really at the end of their resources now, I believe, and I heard that their steamers had been attached in Colombo so that liquidation cannot be far off now. Your prediction did not quite come off though very nearly.'[61] What Ashe predicted is not known; but that both Wynch and Ashe were overjoyed at the Swadeshi Steam Navigation Company hurtling towards its end is abundantly clear.